

CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

AI Career Copilot for Indian Freshers

Prepared for Rupesh | 25 July 2026 | Follow-up to the Startup Validation Report

Executive Summary

This blueprint takes the validated problem from the Startup Validation Report — Indian freshers failing ATS filters, guessing at in-demand skills, and unable to afford premium coaching — and translates it into a buildable MVP. It defines exactly who to build for, what to build first, what to deliberately skip, and how to run the next 30 days.

Input	Summary
Idea	AI career copilot (resume + jobs + interview prep + skills) for Indian freshers
Problem	ATS rejection, skill misdirection, unaffordable coaching, fragmented tools
Customers	Final-year students & freshers, 18-24, Tier 2/3 India
Validation	Founder-built prototype, organic LinkedIn traction, zero paying users yet
Competitors	Internshala, Unstop, Testbook, Naukri/Foundit, Kickresume/Rezi, DIY ChatGPT/Claude

Ideal Customer Profile

Attribute	Profile
Life stage	Final-year undergrad or graduate within 0-12 months of finishing college
Age / Geography	18-24, Tier 2/3 Indian cities (e.g., Lucknow, Kanpur, Indore, Bhopal)
Economic profile	Middle/lower-middle income; cannot afford ₹15K-50K coaching
Digital behavior	Smartphone-first; active on Instagram/YouTube/LinkedIn; casual ChatGPT/Claude use
Core need	An affordable, believable, step-by-step path to "job ready"

Buyer Persona — "Ambitious Ananya"

Age / Location	21, final-year BCA, Tier 2 city
Goal	Land a ₹3.5-6 LPA entry-level job within 3 months of graduating
Frustration	Resumes rejected silently; unsure which skills recruiters want; can't afford coaching
Trigger to buy	Sees a peer's before/after resume or interview win on social media
Willingness to pay	₹99-499/month if it visibly improves call-back rate

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

- Resume gets rejected with no explanation why
- Doesn't know which skills employers actually want
- Can't afford ₹15K+ coaching or placement bootcamps
- Applies to dozens of jobs with no strategy, gets no replies
- Freezes in interviews from lack of real practice/feedback
- Unsure if using ChatGPT/Claude correctly for career help
- No single place to track application progress
- Generic online advice doesn't match their specific target role
- Doesn't know how to translate coursework into resume bullets
- Feels anxious/behind compared to Tier 1 college peers

Customer Journey: Awareness -> Consideration -> Purchase -> Retention

Stage	Experience	Your Move
Awareness	Sees a LinkedIn/Instagram post about AI resume scoring or a peer's result	Publish proof-driven content (before/after resumes, ATS scores)
Consideration	Tries a free resume/ATS check to test credibility	Zero-friction free tool that delivers value in under 5 minutes
Purchase	Wants deeper help - mock interviews, tailored applications	Introduce a low-ticket paid tier right after the free "aha" moment
Retention	Uses the platform weekly while job-hunting	Track outcomes, send nudges, show visible progress over time

Key Customer Objections

Objection	Response
"I can just use ChatGPT/Claude myself for free"	Pre-built, India-specific ATS/job-market system beats raw prompting
"I don't trust another job platform"	Lead with free, visible value before any payment ask
"I don't have money to spend right now"	Rs99-299 pricing framed against the cost of one missed offer
"How is this different from Internshala/Naukri?"	Unified AI copilot journey vs. their fragmented listings

Key Buying Triggers

- Final semester begins, placement pressure rises
- A resume gets rejected or ghosted repeatedly
- A peer gets a callback using an AI-optimized resume
- An upcoming interview with only days to prepare

MVP Recommendation

Build first

- AI resume upload + instant ATS compatibility score with specific, actionable fixes
- Role-based skill-gap check (compares resume to a target job description)

Do NOT build yet

- Full job board / listings aggregation - competitors already own this at scale
- Paid courses or certification content - high-effort, not the validated wedge
- Native mobile app - web-first is sufficient to test demand

Success metrics (first 30 days)

Metric	Target
Free tool completions	100 users
Free-to-paid conversion	5-10%
Resume re-upload / return rate	>=30%
Testimonials collected	5+

MoSCoW Prioritization

Priority	Items
Must Have	AI resume upload + ATS score, actionable fix suggestions, role-based skill-gap check
Should Have	Save/track multiple resume versions, basic mock-interview Q&A, progress dashboard
Could Have	LinkedIn profile review, curated free learning resource links, referral incentives
Won't Have (now)	Full job board, paid course marketplace, native mobile app, employer-facing tools

Pricing Hypothesis

Tier	Price	Includes
Free	Rs0	1 resume ATS score + top 3 fixes
Starter	Rs99/mo	Unlimited resume scoring, skill-gap check, tailored suggestions
Pro	Rs299/mo	Starter + AI mock interviews + application tracking

Top 5 Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Incumbents copy the AI-copilot feature quickly	Move fast on the narrow wedge; build a trust/content moat
Tier 2/3 price sensitivity limits paid conversion	Freemium model; prove ROI before any upsell
Solo founder - limited GTM bandwidth	Focus on one channel (LinkedIn/campus groups) only, for now
AI/API cost scaling faster than revenue	Track unit economics per user from day one
Low initial trust ("another job platform")	Lead every touchpoint with free, provable value

30-Day MVP Plan

Week	Focus	Key Actions
Week 1	Narrow the wedge	Build resume upload + ATS scorer; run 10 customer-discovery interviews
Week 2	Ship the MVP	Launch a simple landing page + working scorer, no login friction
Week 3	Drive first users	Share in college groups, LinkedIn, relevant communities; collect feedback
Week 4	Test willingness to pay	Introduce Rs99-199 paid feature; track conversion, retention, testimonials

Founder Action Sheet - Top 10 Next Actions

- Build the resume-upload + ATS-scoring MVP this week
 - Write and send 10 customer-discovery interview requests
 - Publish 3 proof-driven LinkedIn posts (before/after resumes)
 - Launch a no-login landing page for the free tool
 - Share the tool in 5+ college WhatsApp/Telegram groups
- Set up a simple analytics tracker (completions, conversion)
 - Draft Rs99/Rs299 pricing page copy for Week 4 test
 - Collect 5 testimonials from early users
 - Log every objection heard during interviews
 - Review Day-30 metrics against the Go/No-Go checkpoint

Scores (0-100)



Final Verdict

PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

Problem severity and MVP readiness are strong - the pain is real and a narrow MVP is buildable within days. Customer clarity and PMF potential are held back by the same gap: zero market-level validation so far. The 30-day plan above exists specifically to move this from yellow to green.